

FAT32 on Linux

Q. I have a Pentium III system with 128 MB SDRAM and a 20 GB Samsung hard disk. I had three operating systems: Mandrake Linux 7.1, Windows XP and Windows 98. Earlier I was able to access all Windows partitions from Linux, but I recently switched from Mandrake to RedHat Linux 7.2. Now I am not able to access the FAT32 partitions. Is there any way to access these in RedHat?

Ezhil

Via e-mail

A Mounting a FAT32 filesystem requires FAT32 support either in the kernel or as a module. First, create a mount point using the following command:

```
mkdir /mnt/windows
```

You can use the following command to mount the FAT32 partition on Linux:

```
mount /dev/hda1 /mnt/windows
```

If this does not work, use this mount command instead:

```
mount -t vfat /dev/hda1 /mnt/windows
```



You will now be able to access the FAT32 partition from `/mnt/windows/`. Note that here it is assumed that `hda1` is the FAT32 partition. Replace this with the appropriate device ID on your system. Instead of `vfat` as the module, you can also use `msdos`, though in this case you will lose out on FAT32 features such as long filenames.

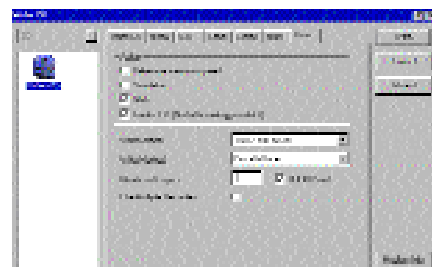
To mount the partition every time the system boots, add its entry to the `/etc/fstab` file in any text editor.

burnt to 100 per cent and the software is writing the Lead Out, the CD-Writer stops working, but sometimes it burns successfully. I write the CDs at 8x. Is this happening due to a software error or is there a fault with the hardware? Please help.

Deep Sanjay

Via e-mail

A There could be several reasons for the burn to fail. The media itself could be a problem, especially since some CDs burn well and others don't. You can try changing the CD-Rs to see if that helps. It may also help to reboot the machine once and turn off all other applications before burning a CD. Also, ensure that



Finalise the CD and enable Burn-Proof when writing VCDs with Nero

the burn settings are all correct. Do not keep the compilation open when burning VCDs. Also, you may want to turn off Simulation and enable the Burn-Proof feature. Also try reducing the burning speed.

Inconsistent disks

Q. I have a PC with an AMD Duron 800 MHz processor, 128 MB RAM, one 8.4 GB and one 1.2 GB hard disk. The first disk has two partitions—the first partition has Windows 98 and the second partition has Linux. Recently, I upgraded from Windows 98 to Windows 2000 Professional. The installation went smoothly, but whenever I start the machine, I get the following error: 'Checking File System on C:, Type of File System is FAT32. One of your disks needs to be checked for consistency. You may cancel the disk check, but it is strongly recommended that you continue'. If I allow the disk checking to continue, no problem is found. This happens every time though I shut down the system properly.

Vaibhav Sharma

Via e-mail

Windows. It boots properly now, but the machine hangs often and Scandisk regularly reports that drive C is showing incorrect space. What is the actual problem and how can I fix it?

Koushik

Via e-mail

A The VFAT error occurs if the `ifshlp.sys` file is missing or corrupted. You can simply replace this file for Windows to work. However, since you've already fixed that, the new problem looks like it's related to the hard disk. Run a thorough Scandisk and repair any problems with the hard disk, first from DOS, then from Windows. The Scandisk that runs automatically does not do a thorough check. Once all the disk errors are fixed, so should the problem.

No sound

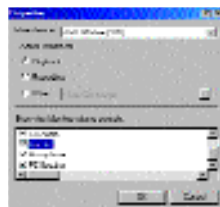
Q. I have recently installed a TV-Tuner card with FM support, but when I connect the sound cable from the Audio Out on the TV-Tuner card to the Audio In on the motherboard, I can't hear any sound. If I directly connect my speakers to the Audio Out of the TV-Tuner card,

I can hear the sound. What could be the problem?

Pradip Makwana

Via e-mail

A The volume for the Line In for the soundcard is probably set very low or may even be muted. Double-click the Volume icon on the taskbar to bring up the Volume Controls. Click Properties and enable all devices to be displayed on the Volume Control. Look for options such as Auxiliary, Line In or TV-



Enable Volume Control for the Line In channel on the soundcard

Tuner (depending on the soundcard installed) and check the volume. Make sure it is not set to mute and raise the volume until you can hear the sound.

Burning issues

Q. I have a Pentium III 600 MHz system running Windows 98. I use Nero to burn VCDs, but these days I am facing a peculiar problem. When the CD is